The Planning Folder

One page for where Mom's care notes, financial summary, legal documents and contacts are kept.

The will is in Mom's desk, the statements are in a folder in the hall closet, and your notes about how she's been doing are in your phone.

This page doesn't ask you to read or understand any of it. It asks where each thing is, how recent it is, and who has it. The pieces can stay where they are. This is the index.

WHAT THE PLAN DRAWS ON	WHERE IT'S KEPT	ITS DATE	WHO HOLDS IT
Notes on how Mom is managing now			
What Mom has said she'd want if she needed more help			
The summary of her finances, and the statements behind it			
What you've read or been told about Medicaid, and who said it			
Her will, and any other legal documents you know she has signed			
Her insurance policies			
Family members taking part in planning, with phone numbers			
Professionals the family already knows: her doctor, and any attorney, tax professional, or financial or insurance professional			
The list of what your family is keeping an eye on			
Your open questions, and who each one goes to			

What hasn't turned up yet, and who will look for it

Anything above with an empty line. Put a name next to each.

FOR EXAMPLE The will is in the desk, but nobody knows the date on it. Karen will look the next time she visits.

How to use it

- Write the date printed on each item. If it has no date, write “undated.”
- Don't rewrite or summarize a document here. Just say where it is.
- Put the date you filled in this page at the top, and add a date each time you look at it again.
- Tell the family members taking part where this page and the papers are kept.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any document says or means, or whether a paper is current or does what the family thinks it does. If you read something you don't understand, that's a question for the person who wrote it, or for your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where each piece is kept and which ones haven't turned up. The planning interview draws on the same pieces: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can keep in the folder and bring to any conversation about paying for care.

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WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The suggestion to tell family members where the papers are kept follows AARP's legal checklist for family caregivers. The rows come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's own working list for this step.

1. AARP, A Legal Checklist for Family Caregivers